



BITLICENSE

031 / 24 JUN 2015 / NEW YORK / RARE

RULES FOR A NEW FRONTIER

A young man approaches a wall of glass and steel, a BITLICENSE APPLICATION folder under his arm. Warm light spills from One State Street onto wet pavement; above him, the tower fills the sky. This imagined scene brings a business built around borderless digital money to the door of a state regulator.

On 24 June 2015, New York's Department of Financial Services made its virtual-currency business regulation effective. Commonly called the BitLicense, it added Part 200 to Title 23 of the New York Codes, Rules and Regulations. The adoption notice records filing on 10 June and an effective date of 24 June. The card marks the day the framework took effect.

The rules covered specified virtual-currency business activities involving New York or its residents, including custody, transmission and customer exchange services. Consumers using virtual currency solely for investment, and merchants or consumers using it solely to buy or sell goods or services, were exempt from the licensing requirement. The outline on the folder keeps the jurisdiction visible: a state framework, rather than a worldwide rule for everyone holding bitcoin.

Businesses within its scope faced requirements covering capital, customer assets, records, anti-money-laundering controls and cybersecurity. DFS described its purpose as protecting consumers and strengthening the safety of licensed providers. The folder suggests the work of entering that system; it does not show a licence already granted. Circle received the first BitLicense on 22 September 2015, a separate milestone. Here, the anonymous applicant is still approaching the door. RULES FOR A NEW FRONTIER is an editorial caption for that encounter, not an official quotation.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE APPLICATION FOLDER

The words BITLICENSE APPLICATION identify the business-licensing subject. The tan folder and the person carrying it are invented narrative props, not a documented applicant or a reproduction of an official application pack.

02 THE NEW YORK OUTLINE

The small state outline connects the folder to New York's jurisdiction. It is an illustrative symbol, not an authenticated government seal. Its placement distinguishes the setting without implying a federal or global law.

03 ONE STATE STREET

The entrance sign places the scene at DFS's Manhattan office address in 2015. The dark rectangular tower and curved silver neighbour anchor the composition. Its looming scale expresses institutional weight; the warm entrance, people and wet street are an interpretation, not an exact reconstruction of a 2015 visit.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

The [New York State Register](#), 24 June 2015, pp. 7-8 records the dates, Part 200 and the rule's requirements. [DFS licensing guidance](#) explains scope and exemptions; its [22 September announcement](#) identifies Circle as the first recipient. [June 2015 DFS letterhead](#) confirms One State Street. Architecture reference: [Tdorante10, One State Street Plaza, 27 March 2018, CC BY-SA 4.0](#), adapted as a drawn scene. The entrance is interpretive; no historical handover is claimed.